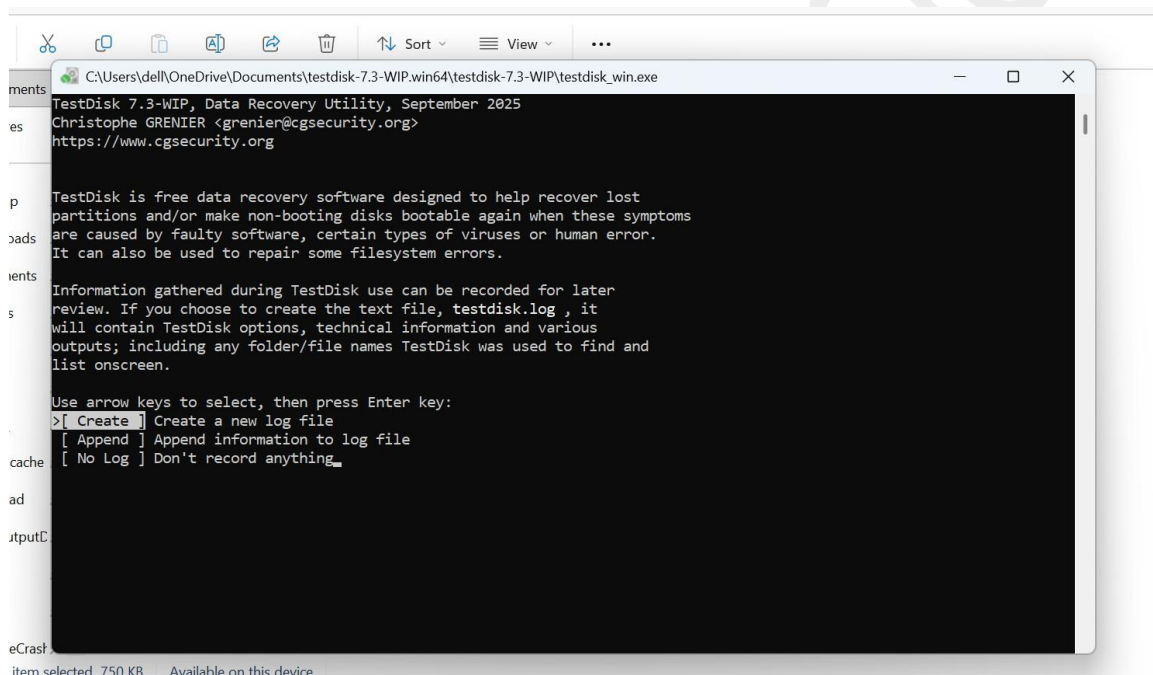


Ex.No.2	Recover deleted or damaged files from a storage device using Test Disk
Date	

Description:

TestDisk step by step to recover a missing partition and corrupted one. Log

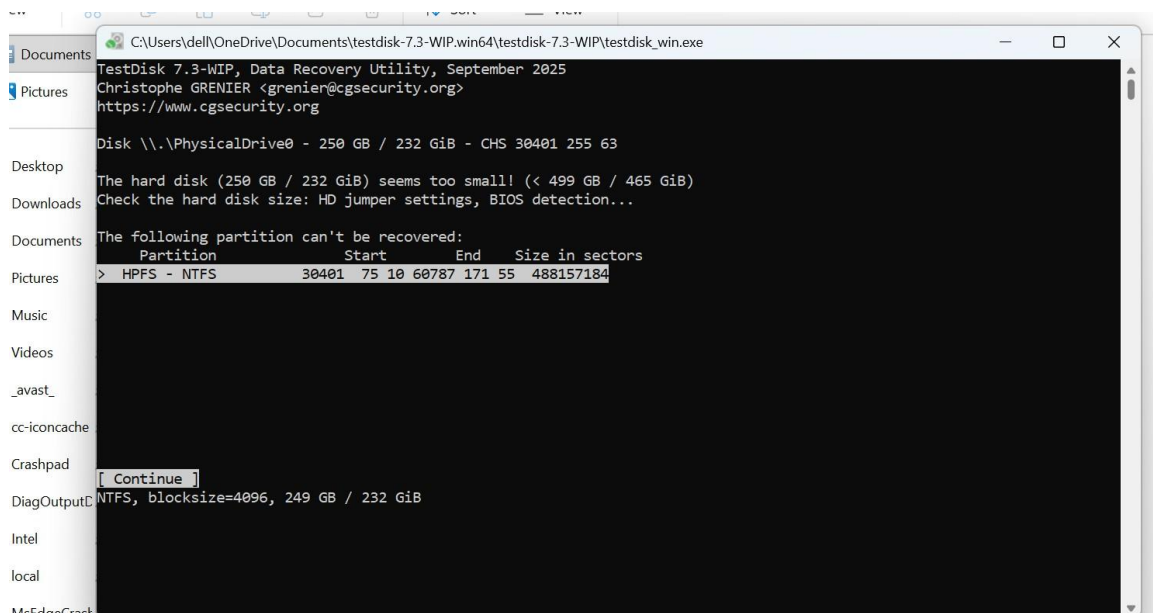
Creation



- Choose Create to instruct Testdisk to create a **log file** containing technical information and messages, unless you have a reason to append data to the **log** or you execute TestDisk from read only media and must create the **log** elsewhere.
- Choose None if you do not want messages and details of the process to be written into a **log file** (useful if for example Testdisk was started from a read-only location).
- Press Enter to proceed.

Disk Selection

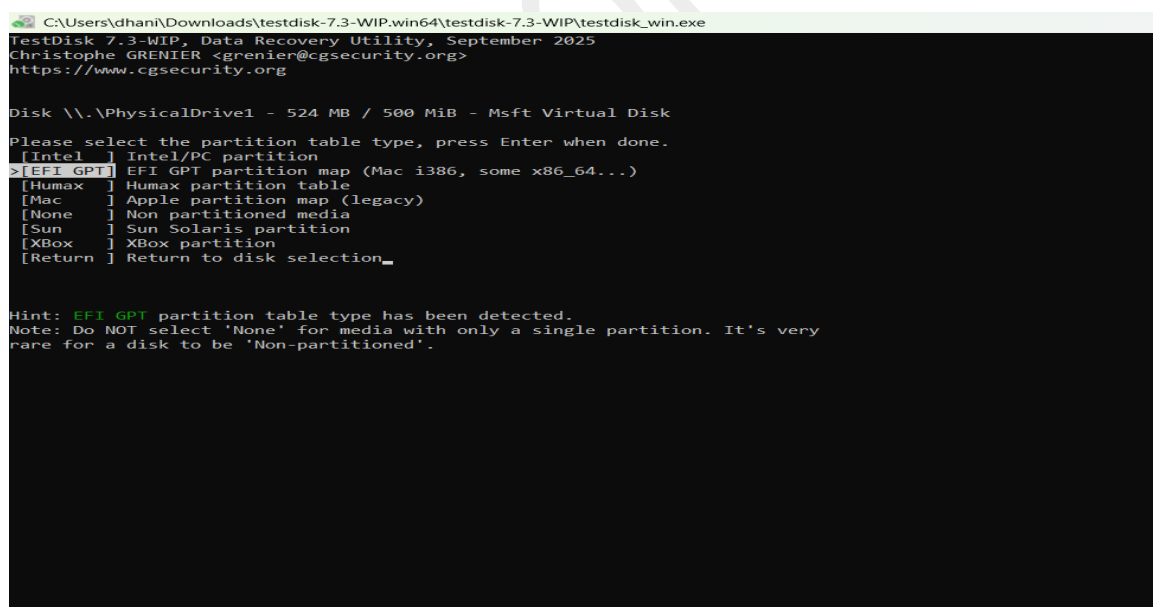
All hard drives should be detected and listed with the correct size by TestDisk:



- Use up/down arrow keys to select your hard drive with the lost partition/s.
- Press Enter to Proceed.
- If available, use raw device /dev/rdisk* instead of /dev/disk* for faster data transfer.

Partition Table Type Selection

TestDisk displays the partition table types.



- Select the partition table type - usually the default value is the correct one as TestDisk auto-detects the partition table type.
- Press Enter to Proceed.

Current Partition Table Status

```

C:\Users\dnani\Downloads\testdisk-7.3-WIP.win64\testdisk-7.3-WIP\testdisk_win.exe
TestDisk 7.3-WIP, Data Recovery Utility, September 2025
ristophe GRENIER <grenier@cgsecurity.org>
https://www.cgsecurity.org

Disk \\.\PhysicalDrive1 - 524 MB / 500 MiB - Msft Virtual Disk
CHS 63 255 63 - sector size=512

Analyse ] Analyse current partition structure and search for lost partitions
Advanced ] Filesystem Utils
Geometry ] Change disk geometry
Options ] Modify options
Quit ] Return to disk selection

Note: Correct disk geometry is required for a successful recovery. 'Analyse'
process may give some warnings if it thinks the logical geometry is mismatched.

```

TestDisk displays the menus (also see [TestDisk Menu Items](#)).

- Use the default menu "Analyse" to check your current partition structure and search for lost partitions.
- Confirm at Analyse with Enter to proceed.

Now, your current partition structure is listed. Examine your current partition structure for missing partitions and errors.

```

C:\Users\dnani\OneDrive\Documents\testdisk-7.3-WIP.win64\testdisk-7.3-WIP\testdisk_win.exe
TestDisk 7.3-WIP, Data Recovery Utility, September 2025
Christophe GRENIER <grenier@cgsecurity.org>
https://www.cgsecurity.org

Disk \\.\PhysicalDrive0 - 250 GB / 232 GiB - CHS 30401 255 63
Current partition structure:
Partition      Start      End      Size in sectors
1 P EFI GPT    0 0 2 267349 89 4 4294967295
Bad sector count:
No partition is bootable

+=Primary bootable P=Primary L=Logical E=Extended D=Deleted
[Quick Search] [Backup] Try to locate partition

```

The first partition is listed twice which points to a corrupted partition or an invalid partition table entry.

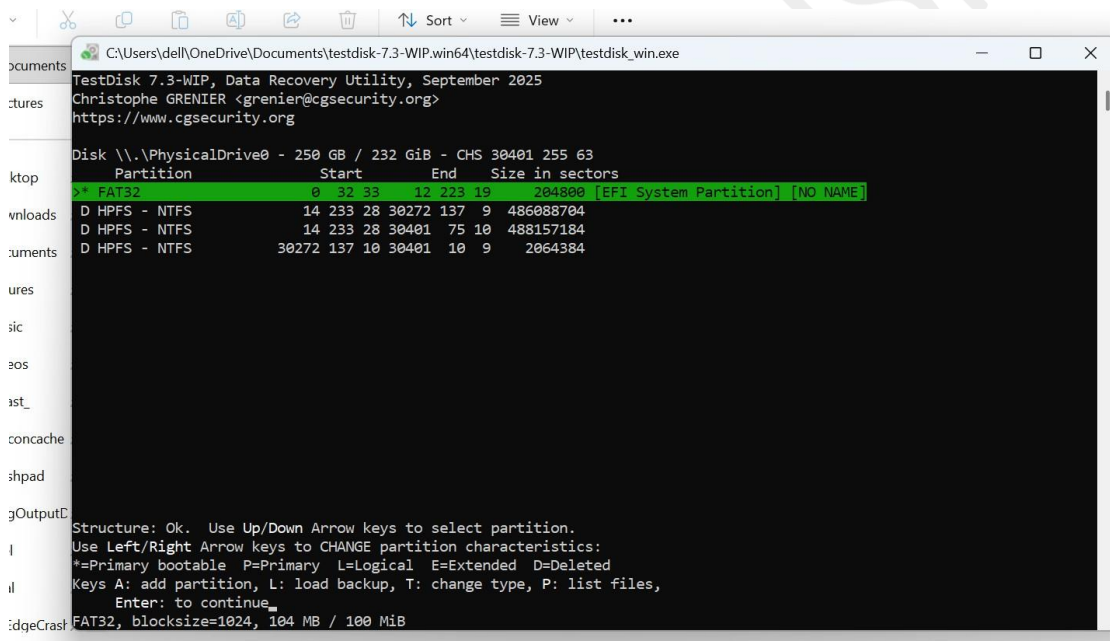
Invalid NTFS boot points to a faulty NTFS boot sector, so it's a corrupted filesystem.

Only one logical partition (label Partition 2) is available in the extended partition. One logical partition is missing.

- Confirm at **Quick Search** to proceed.

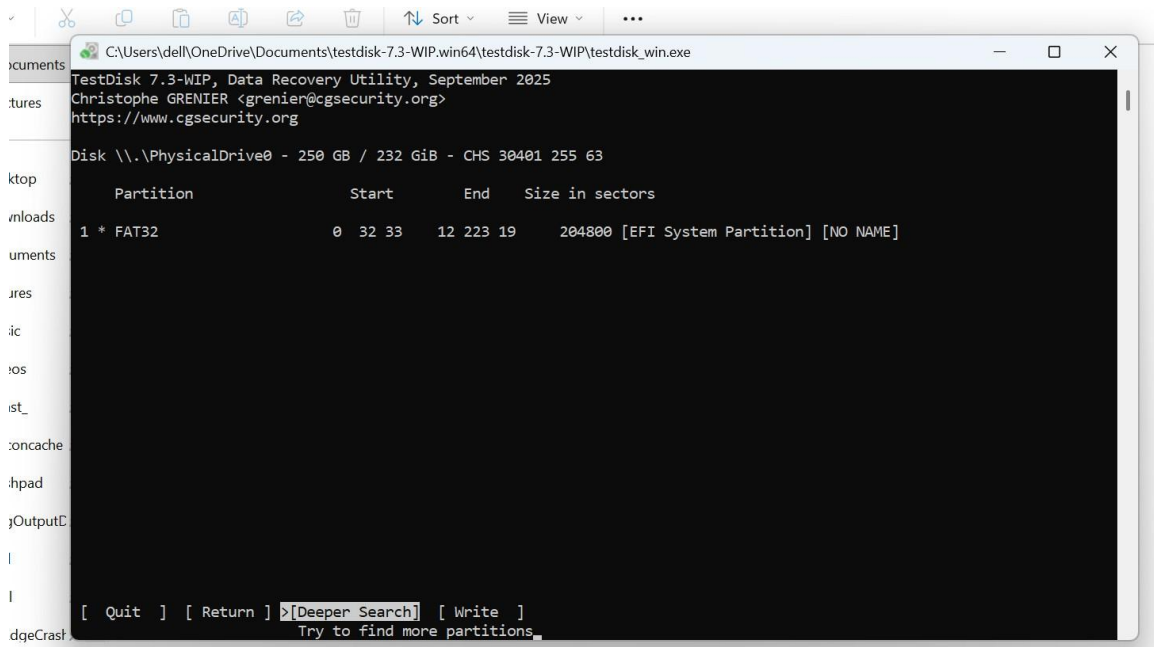
Quick Search for partitions

TestDisk displays the first results in real time.



- Highlight this partition and press **p** to list your files (to go back to the previous display, press q to Quit, Files listed in red are deleted entries).
- All directories and data are correctly listed.
- Press Enter to proceed.

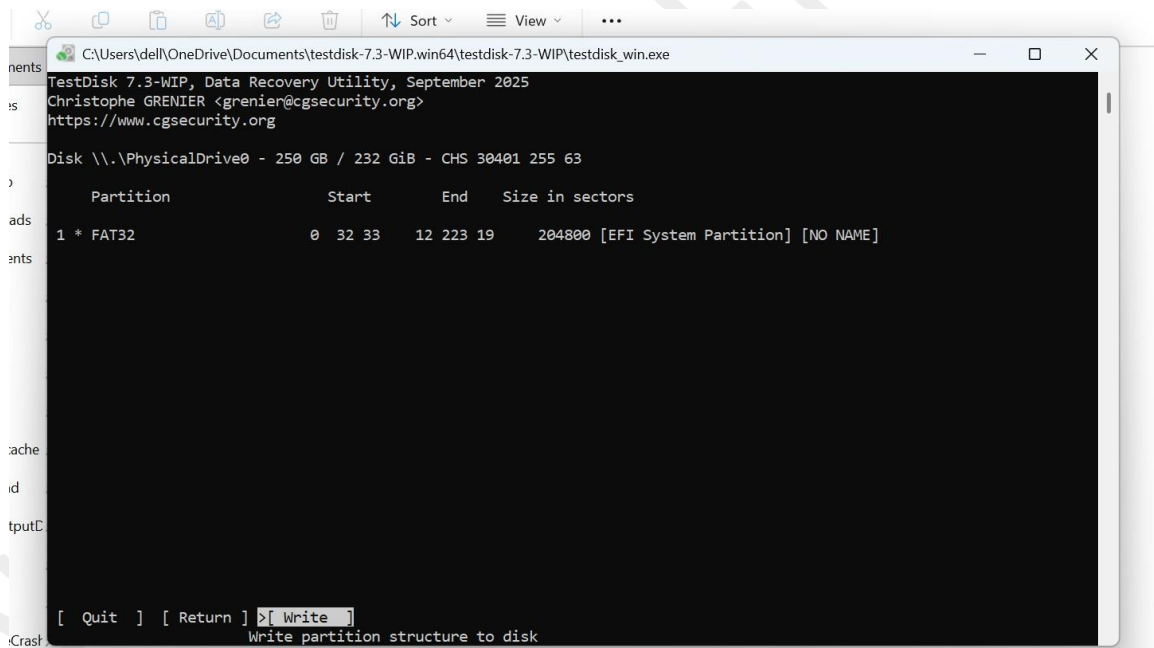
Save the partition table or search for more Partitions?



Partition table recovery

It's now possible to write the new partition structure.

Note: The extended partition is automatically set. TestDisk recognizes this using the different partition structure.

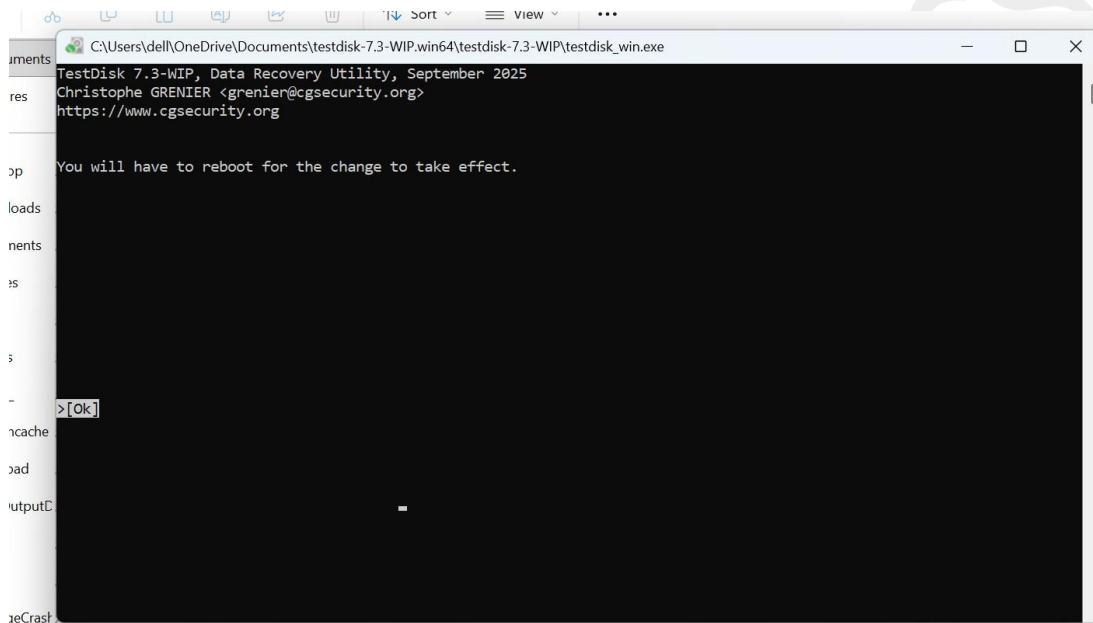


- If **all partitions are listed** and only in this case, confirm at **Write** with Enter, y and OK.

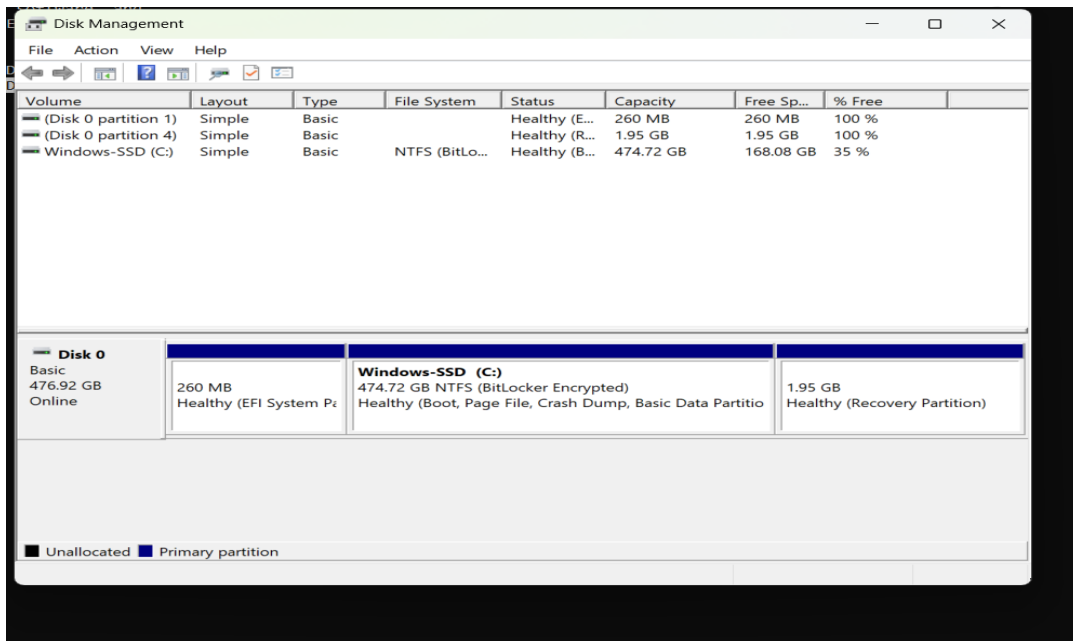
Now, the partitions are registered in the partition table.

NTFS Boot sector Recovery

The boot sector of the first partition named Partition 1 is still damaged. It's time to fix it. The status of the NTFS boot sector is bad and the backup boot sector is valid. Boot sectors are not identical.



- TestDisk displays ***You have to restart your Computer to access your data*** so press Enter a last time and reboot your computer.



Rubrics:

Criteria & Marks Assigned	Mark Allotted	Mark Awarded
1. GitHub Activity & Submission Regularity	3	
2. Application of Forensic Tools & Practical Execution	3	
3. Documentation & Reporting	2	
4. Engagement, Problem-Solving & Team Collaboration	2	
Total	10	

Result:

TestDisk successfully identified and recovered the missing partition and repaired the damaged NTFS boot sector.

The recovered partition structure was restored, allowing access to the stored data after restarting the computer.